

MORUS

M. alba ‘Laciniata’ (White mulberry) illus. p.88. **‘Pendula’** is a deciduous, weeping tree. H 10ft (3m), S 15ft (5m). Rounded, sometimes lobed, glossy, deep green leaves turn yellow in fall. Edible, ovate, fleshy, pink, red or purple fruits ripen in summer. Z4–8

M. nigra (Black mulberry). Deciduous, round-headed tree. H 40ft (12m), S 50ft (15m). Heart-shaped, dark green leaves turn yellow in fall. Bears edible, ovate, succulent, dark purplish-red fruits in late summer or early fall. Z6–10. **‘Chelsea’** has large, succulent fruits; starts cropping early in life.

MUCUNA

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of vigorous, evergreen, twining climbers and shrubs, grown for their large, pealike flowers. Frost tender. Humus-rich, moist but well-drained soil is essential, with partial shade in summer. Water freely when in full growth, less at other times. Needs plenty of space to climb; provide support. Thin out crowded stems in spring. Propagate by seed in spring or by layering in late summer. Whitefly and red spider mite may cause problems.

M. bennettii (New Guinea creeper). Strong- and fast-growing, evergreen, twining climber. H 50–80ft (15–25m). Leaves are divided into 3 ovate leaflets. In summer has pendent clusters of pealike, orange-scarlet flowers. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

M. deeringiana. See *M. pruriens* var. *utilis*.

M. pruriens var. *utilis*, syn. *M. deeringiana*. Vigorous, evergreen, twining climber. H 50ft (15m) or more. Leaves, of 3 ovate leaflets, are used for fodder and green manure. Has pealike, both green- and red-purple flowers in long, pendent clusters in summer and fall. May be short-lived. Z10–12 (min. 46°F/8°C)

MUEHLENBECKIA

POLYGONACEAE

Genus of deciduous or evergreen, slender-stemmed, summer-flowering shrubs and woody-stemmed, scrambling climbers, grown for their foliage. Frost hardy to frost tender. Grow in sun or partial shade and in well-drained soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer.

M. axillaris of gardens. See *M. complexa*.

M. complexa, syn. *M. axillaris* of gardens. Deciduous, creeping shrub or twining climber. H to 10ft (3m), S 3ft (1m). Slender, wiry stems bear variably shaped (ovate to fiddle-shaped), dark green leaves. Bears tiny, star-shaped, greenish-white flowers in midsummer that are followed by small, spherical, waxy, white fruits. Z9–11

Mulgedium. See *Cicerbita*.

MURRAYA

RUTACEAE

Genus of evergreen trees and shrubs, grown for their overall appearance. Frost tender. Requires a position in full light or partial shade and in humus-rich, well-drained soil. Water containerized plants freely when in full growth, moderately at

other times. Pruning is tolerated in late winter if necessary. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. Whitefly may be troublesome.

M. exotica. See *M. paniculata*.

M. paniculata, syn. *M. exotica* (Chinese box, Orange jasmine). Evergreen, rounded shrub or tree. H and S 6–12ft (2–4m). Pungently aromatic, edible, glossy, rich green leaves each have ovate leaflets. Bears fragrant, 5-petaled, white flowers in terminal clusters year-round, followed by tiny, egg-shaped, red fruits. Z10–11

MUSA

Banana, Plantain

MUSACEAE

Genus of evergreen, palmlike, suckering perennials, with false stems formed from overlapping leaf sheaths, grown for their foliage, flowers and fruits (bananas), not all of which are edible. Frost hardy to frost tender. In frost-prone areas, grow in a temperate greenhouse, or as summer bedding. In warmer areas, grow in sun or partial shade and in humus-rich, well-drained soil. Propagate by division year-round, by offsets in summer or by suckers after flowering.

M. acuminata ‘Dwarf Cavendish’ (Edible banana, French plantain). Upright, suckering perennial. H and S to 10ft (3m). Has oblong leaf-blades, to 5ft (1.5m) long. Bears pendent clusters of yellow flowers, with reddish-purple bracts, irregularly year-round. Seedless yellow fruits, to 8in (20cm) long, with sweet-tasting, white pulp, are borne in long bunches. Should fruit annually at a minimum temperature of 64°F (18°C). Z9–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

M. arnoldiana. See *Ensete venticosum*.

M. basjoo, syn. *M. japonica* (Japanese banana), illus. p.219.

M. ensete. See *Ensete venticosum*.

M. lasiocarpa (Chinese dwarf banana). Suckering perennial. H to 6ft (1.8m), S to 6ft (2m). Has oblong to lance-shaped, glaucous, gray-green leaves, to 2ft (60cm)long. From the second year of growth, in summer and lasting up to several months, erect flower heads bear clusters of small flowers, each enclosed in a large, bright yellow bract. Has inedible, small fruits. Z8–11

M. ornata (Flowering banana) illus. p.470.

M. sikkimensis (Darjeeling banana). Suckering perennial with red-tinged false stems. H to 12ft (4m), S to 6ft (2m). Has oblong to lance-shaped, yellowish-green leaves, to 6ft (2m) long. Young leaves, flushed reddish-purple beneath, have red midribs. Small flowers, each enclosed in 1–2 large, purplish-red bracts, are borne in pendent spikes. Angular fruits mature to green, then turn brown. Z8–11. **‘Red Tiger’** has bold, reddish-purple marks on the upper leaf surfaces.

M. velutina (Pink banana). Suckering perennial. H 3–6ft (1–1.8m), S 3–5ft (1–1.5m). Has paddle-shaped leaves, to 3ft (1m) long, sometimes flushed purple. In summer, produces upright flower heads with tubular, yellow flowers, each enclosed by a purplish-pink bract, bright pink inside. The small, hairy, pinkish-purple fruits, split when ripe to reveal numerous black seeds. Z9–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

MUSCARI

Grape hyacinth

ASPAGACEAE

Genus of spring-flowering bulbs, each with a cluster of narrowly strap-shaped, basal leaves, usually emerging in spring just before flowers. Leafless flower stems bear dense spikes of small flowers, most of which have constricted mouths. Good for massed displays in a mixed border, for a wild or woodland garden, or for naturalizing in grass. Fully hardy to frost hardy. Requires sun and fairly well-drained soil. Plant in groups in fall. Propagate by division in late summer or by seed in fall.

M. armeniacum illus. p.420.

‘Blue Spike’ is a spring-flowering bulb. H 6–8in (15–20cm), S 3–4in (8–10cm). Has 3–6 long, narrow, semierect, basal leaves. Bears dense spikes of fragrant, bell-shaped, deep blue flowers; constricted mouths have rims of paler blue or white “teeth.”

‘Dark Eyes’ has rich, deep blue flowers with contrasting white mouths.

‘Peppermint’ produces bicolored spikes of pale blue flowers graduating to white at the top. **‘Valerie Finnis’** has dense flower spikes of gray-blue flowers. Z4–8

M. aucheri, syn. *M. lingulatum*, illus. p.420. **‘White Magic’** is a spring-flowering bulb. H 4–6in (10–15cm), S 2in (5cm). Has erect or semierect, narrow, sickle- to spoon-shaped, mid-green leaves. Produces green buds in tight spikes that open to pure white flowers with constricted mouths. Z4–8

M. azureum, syn. *Hyacinthus azureus*, *Pseudomuscari azureum*. Spring-flowering bulb. H 4–6in (10–15cm), S 2–3in (5–8cm). Has 2–3 narrowly spoon-shaped, semierect, basal, grayish-green leaves. Produces a very dense spike of bell-shaped, pale clear blue flowers; mouths have small “teeth” with central, dark blue stripes. May self-seed freely. Z4–8

M. botryoides. Spring-flowering bulb. H 6–8in (15–20cm), S 2–3in (5–8cm). Has 2–4 narrowly spoon-shaped, semierect, basal leaves. Each tiny, nearly round, bright blue flower has a constricted mouth and white-toothed rim. Z4–8. **‘Album’** illus. p.415.

M. comosum, syn. *Leopoldia comosa* (Tassel grape hyacinth). Late spring-flowering bulb. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 4–5in (10–12cm). Produces up to 5 strap-shaped, semierect, basal, gray-green leaves. Bears a loose spike of bell-shaped, fertile, brownish-yellow flowers with a tuft of threadlike, sterile, purplish-blue flowers at the tip. Z5–8. **‘Monstrosum’** see *M.c.* ‘Plumosum’. **‘Plumosum’** (syn. *M.c.* ‘Monstrosum’; Feather grape hyacinth) illus. p.419.

M. latifolium illus. p.403.

M. lingulatum. See *M. aucheri*.

M. macrocarpum, syn. *M. moschatum* var. *flavum*, *M. muscarimi* var. *flavum*, illus. p.421.

M. moschatum var. *flavum*. See *M. macrocarpum*.

M. muscarimi var. *flavum*. See *M. macrocarpum*.

M. neglectum, syn. *M. racemosum*, illus. p.420.

M. pycnantha. See *Bellevalia pycnantha*.

M. racemosum. See *M. neglectum*.

MUSSAENDA

RUBIACEAE

Genus of evergreen perennials, shrubs, subshrubs, and scrambling climbers, grown for their flowers. Frost tender; where temperatures fall below 15°C (59°F) grow in a warm greenhouse. Requires a position in full light and fertile, well-drained soil. Water freely when in full growth, less at other times. Provide support and thin out crowded stems in spring. Propagate by seed in spring or by air-layering in summer. Whitefly and red spider mite may cause problems.

M. erythrophylla. Moderately vigorous, evergreen, scrambling climber. H 20–30ft (6–10m). Has broadly ovate, bright green leaves. In summer, bears small, creamy-white flowers, each with one large, ovate, bractlike, red petal, a red tube, and yellow petal lobes. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)

MUTISIA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and tendril climbers, grown for their long-lasting flower heads. Frost to half hardy. Plant with roots in shade and leafy parts in sun, in well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in fall, by stem cuttings in late spring or summer, or by layering in fall.

M. decurrens illus. p.208.

M. oligodon. Evergreen, tendril climber. H to 5ft (1.5m). Oblong, glossy, green leaves with sharply toothed margins are 1–1½in (2.5–3.5cm) long. From summer to fall, produces long-stalked, daisylike, yellow-centered, pink flower heads. Grow against a low wall or through a shrub. Z6–10

MYOPORUM

SCROPHULARIACEAE

Genus of spreading, prostrate to upright, evergreen shrubs and trees, grown for their overall appearance and as hedges and windbreaks. Frost hardy to frost tender. Prefers full light and well-drained soil; will tolerate poor soil. Water potted specimens moderately. Propagate by seed when ripe or in spring or by semiripe cuttings in late summer.

M. laetum (Ngaio). Evergreen, rounded to upright shrub or tree. H 10–30ft (3–10m), S 6–15ft (2–5m). Has fleshy, ovate, lustrous, bright green leaves. Clusters of small, bell-shaped, white flowers, dotted purple, are borne in summer, then tiny, narrowly oblong, pale to deep red-purple fruits. Z9–11

M. parvifolium illus. p.454.

MYOSOTIDIUM

BORAGINACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen perennial, with forget-me-not-type flowers, that is suitable for mild, coastal areas. Frost hardy. Prefers partial shade and moist soil. Seaweed is recommended as a mulch. Not easy to cultivate, and once established should not be disturbed. Propagate by division in spring or by seed when ripe, in summer or fall.

M. hortensia, syn. *M. nobile* (Chatham Island forget-me-not), illus. p.271.

M. nobile. See *M. hortensia*.